EUROPEAN CENTRAL BANK

EUROSYSTEM

New wave of digital euro innovation platform activities

Annex 3
Communication guidelines

1. Context and objectives of the document

This document provides selected participants in the ECB's digital euro innovation platform with rules that ensure that internal and external communications about their participation are accurate, factual and aligned with official ECB communications. Participants are required to follow the rules included in this document.

The ECB recognises that participants' communications can contribute to a better understanding of the digital euro innovation platform, provided they remain informative and consistent with official ECB communications.

2. Scope of the communication guidelines and consultation requirement

These guidelines apply to all forms of internal and external communication by participants and their subcontractors related to participation in the digital euro innovation platform's experimentation and exploration workstreams, both during participation and after its conclusion, including, but not limited to:

- media engagement (e.g., interviews, press releases, public statements),
- social media activity,
- websites, blogs, podcasts and newsletters,
- public events, conferences, webcasts and panel discussions,
- marketing or promotional material,
- internal communications within the participants' organisations, including communications to staff members about the digital euro innovation activities.

The ECB may publish summary reports for each workstream and focus area and may release a consolidated report covering the outcomes of the experimentation workstream and the exploration workstream through its official communication channels upon the completion of the respective activities. These reports may include selected findings, a list of participants, and high-level descriptions of use cases and innovations explored. The ECB shall communicate to the participants in due course details regarding publication timelines.

The ECB may invite participants to present the outcome/s from their activities at an ECB organised event. Further details will be communicated by participants' designated ECB contact(s) once any arrangements have been confirmed.

3. Communications guidelines

3.1 Core communication principles

All participants' internal and external communications related to their participation in the digital euro innovation platform must:

- (for the experimentation workstream), comply with the provisions of clause 8 of the Contract for experimentation workstream subscribed by the participant,
- (for the exploration workstream), not include any non-public information regarding the exploration activities or non-public information obtained in performance thereof, regardless of the channel or format,
- be accurate and factual,
- be non-speculative and non-forward-looking,
- be neutral and not suggesting or implying ECB endorsement or knowledge of its decisions. Participants shall clearly indicate that any statements they publish are made on behalf of their own organisation.

For the purposes of these guidelines, information is considered confidential where the relevant document or item of information is labelled, orally or in writing, as "ECB-restricted", "ECB-confidential", or "ECB-secret" by the ECB. Participants must treat all documents and information carrying this label as confidential and must not disclose, publish or share them externally.

These principles apply regardless of the communication channel used.

3.2 How participants may communicate about their participation in the digital euro innovation platform

Once the ECB publishes the list of participants, participants may communicate externally about their participation. In particular, participants may:

- state that they are participating in the digital euro innovation platform;
- refer to publicly available information published by the ECB about the digital euro and its innovation platform, including ECB social media posts, using and referencing only official ECB and Eurosystem sources, maintaining the integrity of the message;
- describe their role and activities at a high level, without providing technical details which have not previously been made public by the ECB.

In their communications, participants shall emphasise the exploratory nature of the activities and avoid implying that tested solutions will be implemented;

At the conclusion of the workstream activities, and only upon the publication of summary reports by the ECB, participants may:

- disclose outcome reports based on non-confidential information related to their research/project findings in the workstream. In case of publication, participants should always include the following disclaimer to clarify that the research/project conducted is independent: "This research (or project) was conducted independently and reflects the sole views and analysis of the authors. Any opinions, findings, conclusions, or recommendations expressed herein are entirely those of the authors and do not represent the views or positions of the ECB."

3.3 Restrictions on external communications

Participants shall not, in any external communication, be it proactive or in response to external or internal queries, related to the digital euro innovation platform:

- communicate publicly about their participation before the participant list is officially published by the ECB[1];
- disclose, publish or share information obtained through participation in the digital euro innovation platform that have not previously been made public by the ECB, without the ECB's prior written consent;
- disclose, publish or share information which has been classified as "ECB-restricted", "ECB-confidential", or "ECB-secret" by the ECB;
- suggest that any tested feature, functionality, solution or innovation has been endorsed, selected or approved by the ECB, or will form part of the digital euro;
- present any tested feature, solution or use case as an official or confirmed future element of the digital euro;
- suggest or imply ECB decisions, timelines, commitments, endorsement, partnership or preferential treatment;
- use innovation activities participation as a marketing or promotional tool for the participants' products or services, including implying endorsement, certification or approval by the ECB.

If approached by the media, participants may confirm their involvement in the digital euro innovation platform workstreams, as long as they adhere to these communication guidelines.

[1] The designated ECB contact(s) will confirm the publication date.

3.4 Use of visual identity and logos

Participants acknowledge that the ECB logo is an institutional identifier and may only be used in clearly defined, non-commercial contexts authorised by the ECB. The use of the ECB, SSM or ESRB logos by participants and their subcontractors is not permitted. Where relevant, participants may refer to the European Central Bank in plain text.

If participants wish to use the digital euro logo or other digital euro visual assets, they should contact their designated ECB contact(s) to request the necessary permission and applicable usage guidance. Any intended use of digital euro visual assets must be explicitly indicated in the relevant approval request and must not imply any endorsement or support of participants' services by the ECB.